

THE VOICE OF BLOOD

* Blue - PPT slide

* Brown - Instructions to technician

TEXT: Hebrews 12:24 (NKJV) *“To Jesus the Mediator of the new covenant, and to the blood of sprinkling that speaks better things than that of Abel.”*

INTRO: In the book of Hebrews, the writer argues that Jesus is better than everything else. Hebrews declares Him to be better than:

- The sacrifices
- Abel
- The high priests
- Abraham

Notice this: in chapter twelve the writer states that the blood of Jesus speaks *“Better things than that of Abel.”*

This reference in Hebrews points back to a very interesting Old Testament story. It is a story of a sibling rivalry gone really, really bad.

Genesis 4:1-15 (NKJV) *“Now Adam knew Eve his wife, and she conceived and bore Cain, and said, “I have acquired a man from the Lord.” 2 Then she bore again, this time his brother Abel. Now Abel was a keeper of sheep, but Cain was a tiller of the ground. 3 And in the process of time it came to pass that Cain brought an offering of the fruit of the ground to the Lord. 4 Abel also brought of the firstborn of his flock and of their fat. And the Lord respected Abel and his offering, 5 but He did not respect Cain and his offering. And Cain was very angry, and his countenance fell. 6 So the Lord said to Cain, “Why are you angry? And why has your countenance fallen? 7 If you do well, will you not be accepted? And if you do not do well, sin lies*

at the door. And its desire is for you, but you should rule over it.” 8 Now Cain talked with Abel his brother; and it came to pass, when they were in the field, that Cain rose up against Abel his brother and killed him. 9 Then the Lord said to Cain, “Where is Abel your brother?” He said, “I do not know. Am I my brother’s keeper?” 10 And He said, “What have you done? The voice of your brother’s blood cries out to Me from the ground. 11 So now you are cursed from the earth, which has opened its mouth to receive your brother’s blood from your hand. 12 When you till the ground, it shall no longer yield its strength to you. A fugitive and a vagabond you shall be on the earth.” 13 And Cain said to the Lord, “My punishment is greater than I can bear! 14 Surely You have driven me out this day from the face of the ground; I shall be hidden from Your face; I shall be a fugitive and a vagabond on the earth, and it will happen that anyone who finds me will kill

*me.” 15 And the Lord said to him,
“Therefore, whoever kills Cain, vengeance
shall be taken on him sevenfold.” And the
Lord set a mark on Cain, lest anyone
finding him should kill him.”*

According to this passage of Scripture,
blood has a voice and a vocabulary! If blood
has a voice and a vocabulary, what is it
capable of declaring?

I. BLOOD ANNOUNCES LIFE...

Why is the shedding of innocent blood such
a tremendous offense in the sight of God?

Leviticus 17:11 (NKJV) *“The life of the
flesh is in the blood, and I have given it to
you upon the altar to make atonement for
your souls; for it is the blood that makes
atonement for the soul.”*

When a life is taken:

- A family line is stopped...
- A destiny is destroyed...

- The purpose of God is circumvented...

Abel died at the hands of an angry sibling. He died an innocent man, whose blood was shed senselessly. This event ticked God off.

The shedding of the innocent blood of Abel did not produce one good thing. In fact it prevented Abel from:

- Being a father to his children...
- Contributing to society...
- Completely fulfilling the plan of God for his life...

I would not be in an abortion doctor or nurse's shoes for their socks! The blood of millions of innocent babies' blood is crying out from hospitals and clinics across America and around the world.

On the other hand, the shedding of the innocent blood of Jesus pardoned the world of a desperately sinful condition.

The life is in the blood. The voice of the blood of Jesus says *“Come now, and let us reason together,” Says the Lord, “Though your sins are like scarlet, They shall be as white as snow; Though they are red like crimson, They shall be as wool.”* Isaiah 1:18 (NKJV)

Mahatma Gandhi said, *“A man who was completely innocent, offered himself as a sacrifice for the good of others, including his enemies, and became the ransom of the world. It was a perfect act.”*

II. BLOOD CRIES OUT FOR JUSTICE...

Hebrews 11:4 (NKJV) *“By faith Abel offered to God a more excellent sacrifice than Cain, through which he obtained witness that he was righteous, God testifying of his gifts; and through it he being dead still speaks.”*

Have you ever wondered what the difference was between the two offerings? Over the years, I have assumed that the difference was the fact that Cain's offering was a grain offering and Abel's offering was a blood sacrifice. Throughout the Old Testament God accepted grain offerings, so that was really not a factor. I believe the difference can be found in a couple of verses of Scripture tucked away in this story.

1) Cain's offering – [Genesis 4:3](#) (NKJV) ***“In the process of time it came to pass that Cain brought an offering of the fruit of the ground to the Lord.”***

2) Abel's offering – [Genesis 4:4](#) (NKJV) ***“Abel also brought of the firstborn of his flock and of their fat.”***

What made such a difference between the sacrifices? Cain brought his sacrifice when he got around to it; Abel offered the first-fruit.

Abel offered a sacrifice that touched the heart of God. Our worship should not be designed to make us happy; it should be orchestrated to make God happy.

Abel discerned the heart of God and understood that God desired to be THE priority and gave Him the first-fruit.

The difference was not the cost but the priority. God expects to occupy the number one spot in our lives. [Deuteronomy 5:7](#) (NKJV) ***“You shall have no other gods before Me.”***

We need to quit trying to give God what He doesn't want. I hate it when people try to get me to eat something I don't like. (Pimiento cheese)

Cain did not kill Abel because he was prosperous, but because his sacrifice pleased

God. Some struggles we experience could be the result of having chosen to be spiritual instead of carnal. John 16:33 (NKJV)

“These things I have spoken to you, that in Me you may have peace. In the world you will have tribulation; but be of good cheer, I have overcome the world.”

The blood of Abel was not good and dry before God showed up and asked Cain,
“Where is your brother?”

There is a big difference between being your brother’s keeper and his killer.

Blood has a voice, and Abel’s blood cried out for justice. Genesis 4:11-14 (NKJV)
“You are cursed from the earth, which has opened its mouth to receive your brother’s blood from your hand. 12 When you till the ground, it shall no longer yield its strength to you. A fugitive and a vagabond you shall be on the earth.” 13 And Cain said to the

Lord, “My punishment is greater than I can bear! 14 Surely You have driven me out this day from the face of the ground; I shall be hidden from Your face; I shall be a fugitive and a vagabond on the earth, and it will happen that anyone who finds me will kill me.” Cain made his living tilling the ground and the justice being exacted upon him would be that what used to come easy would be exponentially more difficult.

The reason sin is going to have such an awful eternal consequence is because the sinner has trampled innocent blood under their feet.

The eternal punishment of sin is the result of treating the innocent blood of a savior as nothing more than a passing thought.

The unused blood of the innocent Son of God cries out for justice.

Jesse Duplantis said, *“The blood of Jesus washes away our past, the name of Jesus opens up our future.”*

III. BLOOD CRIES OUT FOR MERCY...

Cain killed his brother Abel. This is the worst crime imaginable, one sibling taking the life of the other!

God does something in this passage of Scripture that I find to be completely off the chain; He promises Cain that no man will take his life. **Genesis 4:15 (NKJV)** *“The Lord said to him (Cain), “Therefore, whoever kills Cain, vengeance shall be taken on him sevenfold.” And the Lord set a mark on Cain, lest anyone finding him should kill him.”*

Talk about mercy! This is mercy at its best!

Abel's blood cried out for justice but never revenge. God takes the demand for justice and turns it to mercy.

The sinful condition of the world cries out for justice, but God seems to always find a way to soften the blow of the gavel of justice with mercy. John Stott said, "*The Gospel is good news of mercy to the undeserving. The symbol of the religion of Jesus is the cross, not the scales.*"

CONCLUSION:

Make no mistake about it, blood has a voice and cries for justice and mercy simultaneously.

The blood of Jesus does two things:

1) Delivers us from the wrath of God. God is angry about sin and will eventually punish everyone who does not hide beneath the blood of mercy.

If we hide beneath the blood that is crying out for mercy, God will not destroy us. If God has decided not to destroy us, it is for sure that the devil can't! That means we are the only one who can bring destruction upon ourselves.

2) Delivers us from ourselves. **Hebrews 9:14 (AV)** ***“How much more shall the blood of Christ, who through the eternal Spirit offered himself without spot to God, purge your conscience from dead works to serve the living God.”***

The blood has the power to deliver us from every self-destructive behavior:

- Habits and vices...
- Lack of self-esteem...
- Promiscuous life styles...
- Life controlling problems...

The blood that Jesus shed two thousand years ago is crying out for justice, but those

who hear the voice of the blood can find
refuge in its mercy.

PLACES PREACHED:

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